

R

Everything you need to know about the R programming language.

R is the most popular language used for data analysis, modelling and visualisation. It is great for linear and non-linear models, parametric and non-parametric tests, clustering and time-series models. It also provides advanced graphics functionality for presentations and analysis.

How was R created?

R was created in 1991 by New Zealand based Ross Ihaka (who is currently working on a new programming language that is quicker and holds more data) and Robert Gentleman. R is based on S, which was developed by John Chambers and others at Bell Labs in 1976. S was originally developed as a series of Fortran libraries to help with internal statistical requirements but was rewritten in C in 1988. This essentially makes R a 40-year-old technology. It was released to the public in 1993 and soon became the de facto language for visualisation and statistical analysis.



R is named after the first alphabets of the first names of its creators – Ross and Robert.